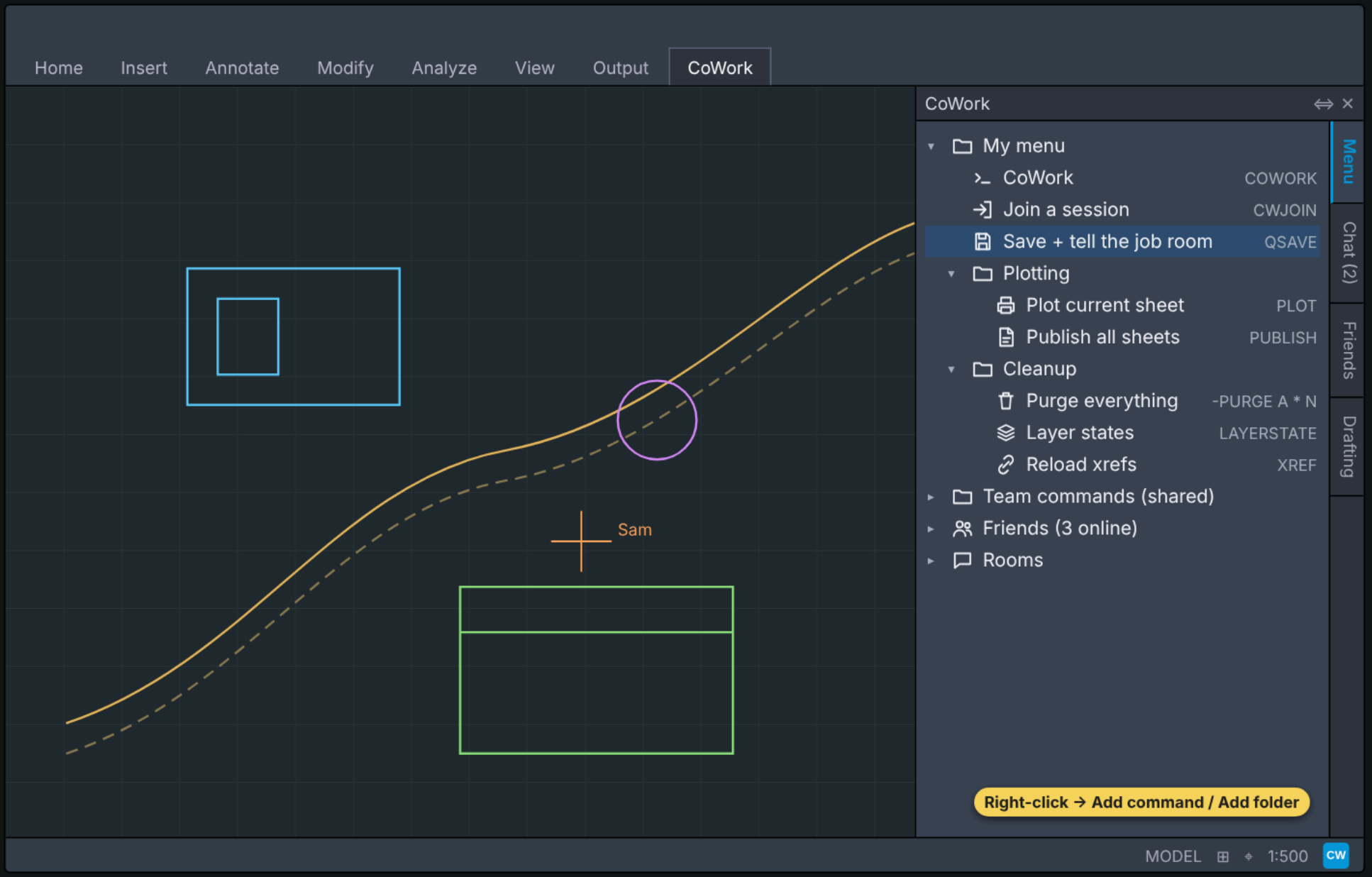
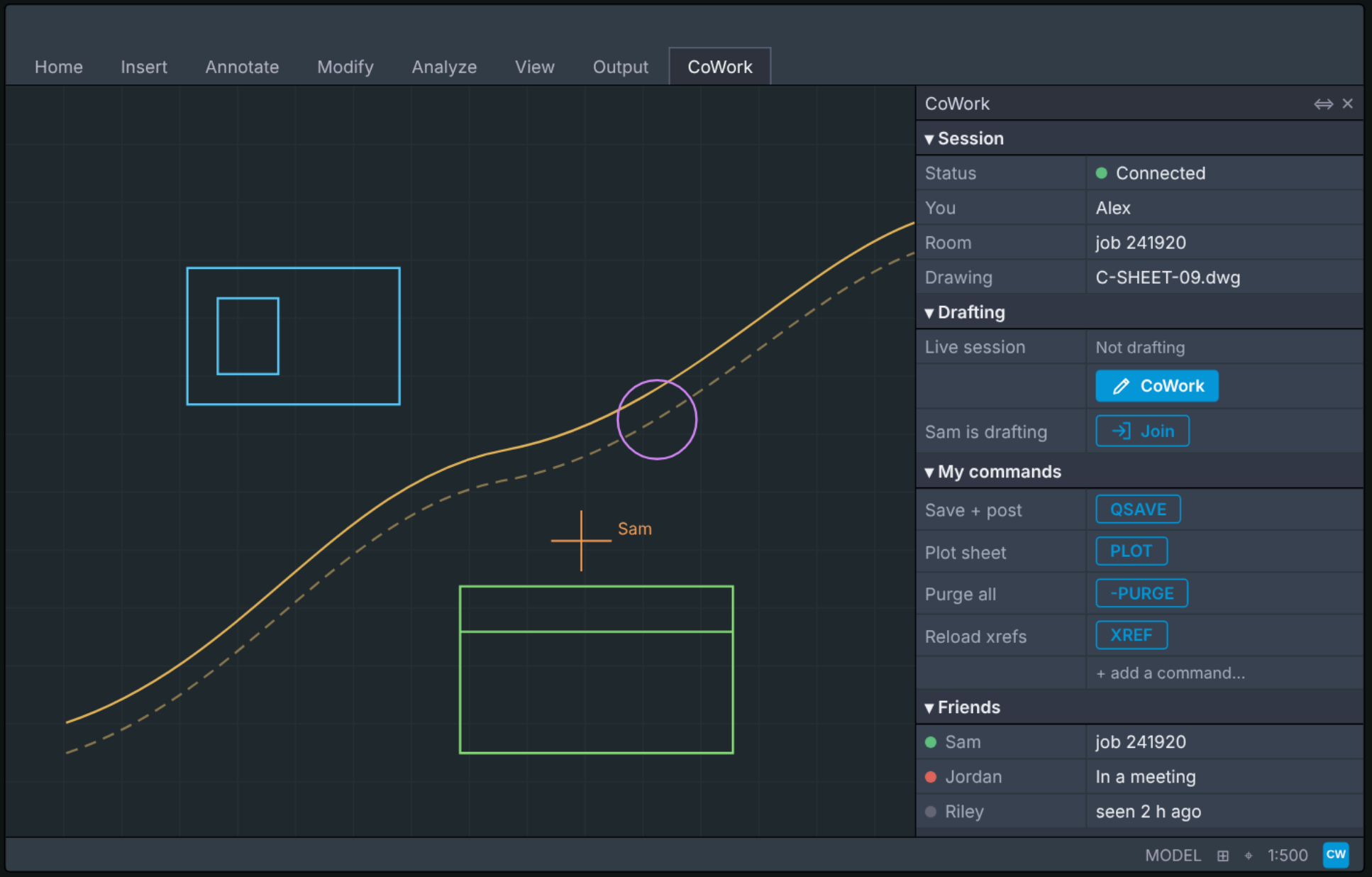
1 · Civil 3D · Toolspace-style: tabs down the side

Works like Toolspace: the tabs run down the edge (Menu, Chat, Friends, Drafting). The Menu tab is a tree you can arrange yourself: folders, your own commands, and right-click to add, rename or reorder. This is the closest match to what you already use.



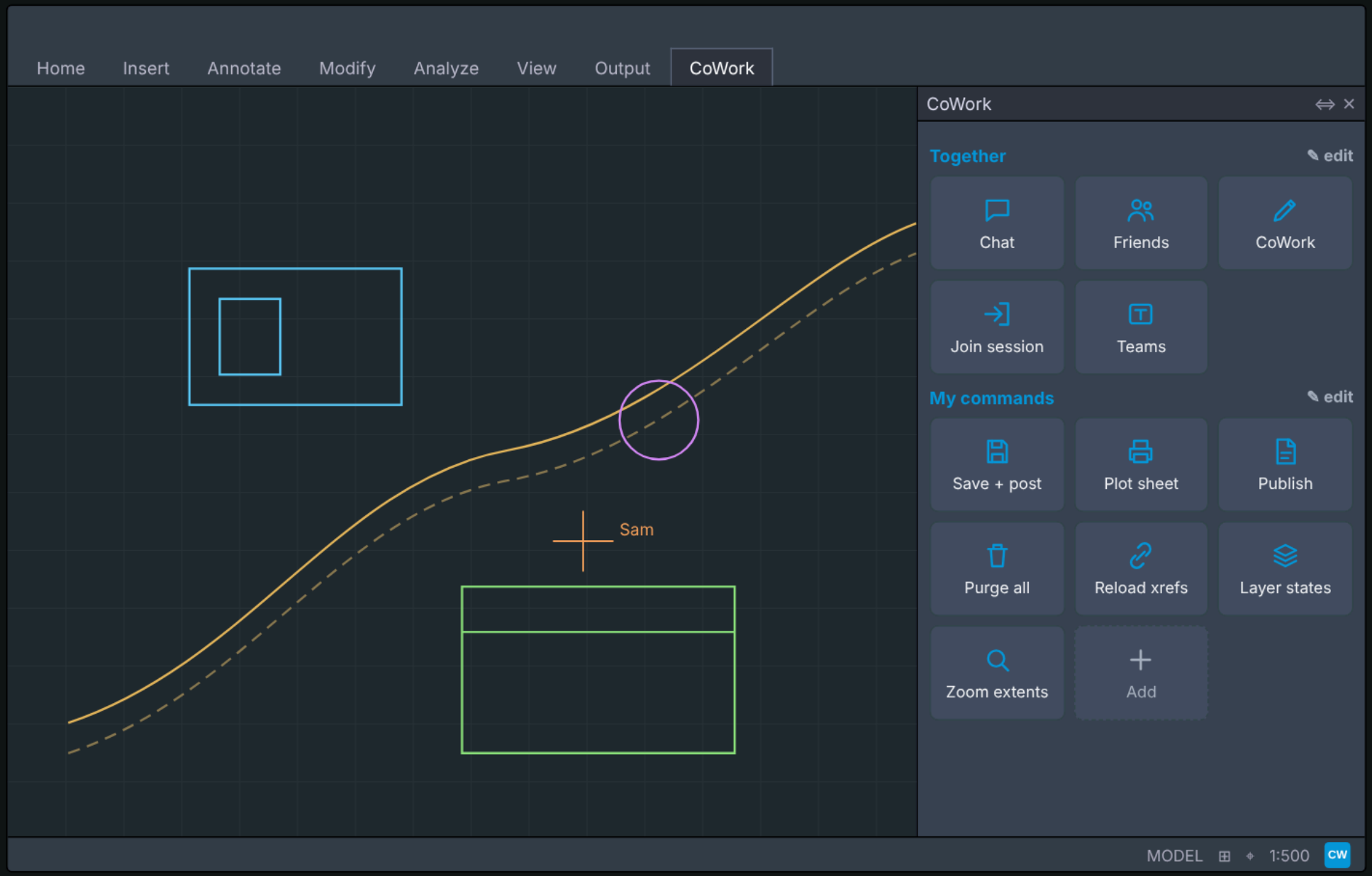
2 · Civil 3D · Properties-style: sections that fold up

Laid out like the Properties panel: sections you can fold up, with a name on the left and a value or button on the right. It's packed with information (who's on, your current room, the drafting status) and your custom commands get their own section.



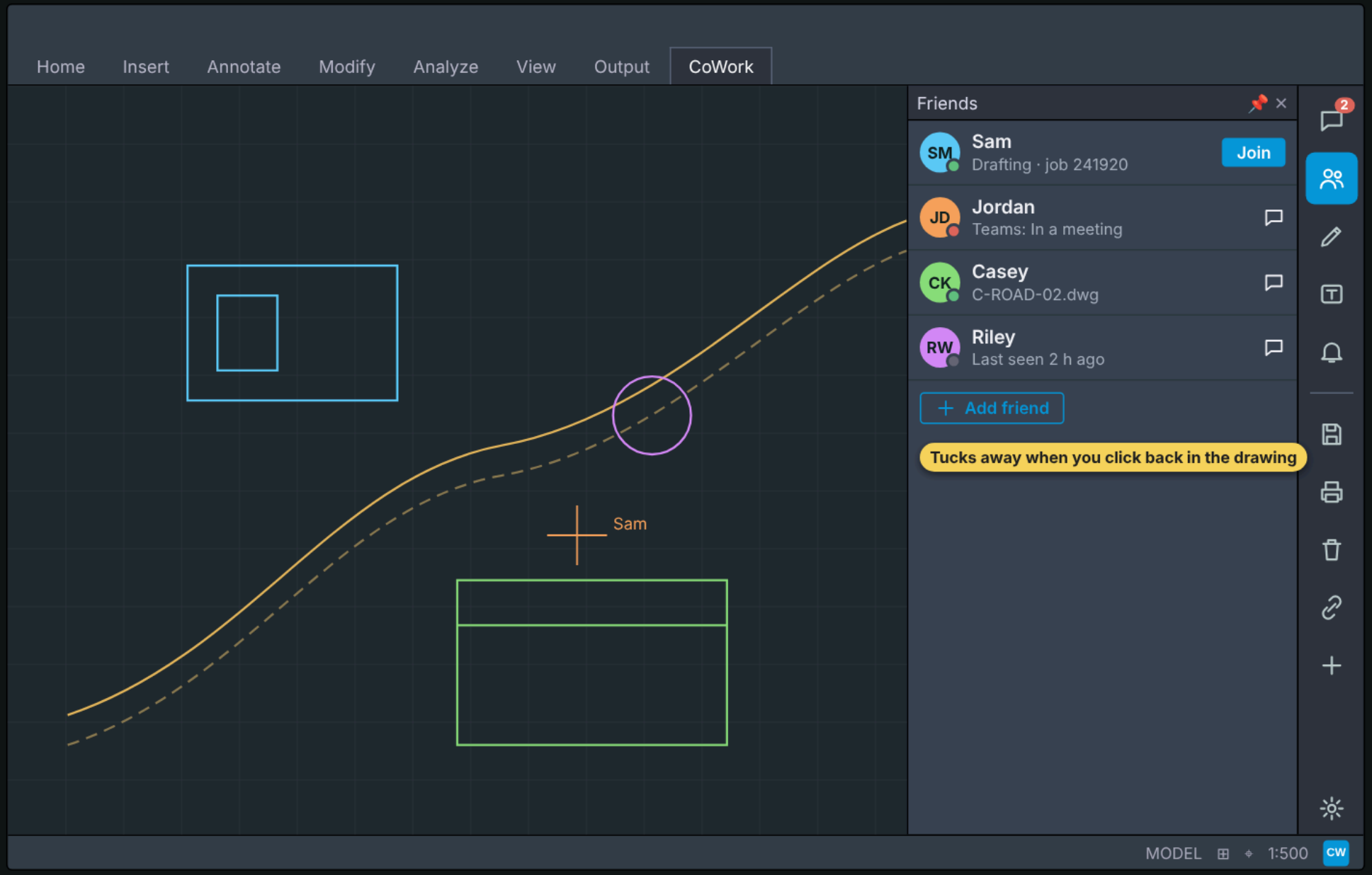
3 · Civil 3D · Tool Palette tiles

Big buttons in groups, like AutoCAD's Tool Palettes. Each tile is one command. Drag tiles to reorder them, and use the dashed "+" tile to add your own. The easiest of the five to click and to customise.



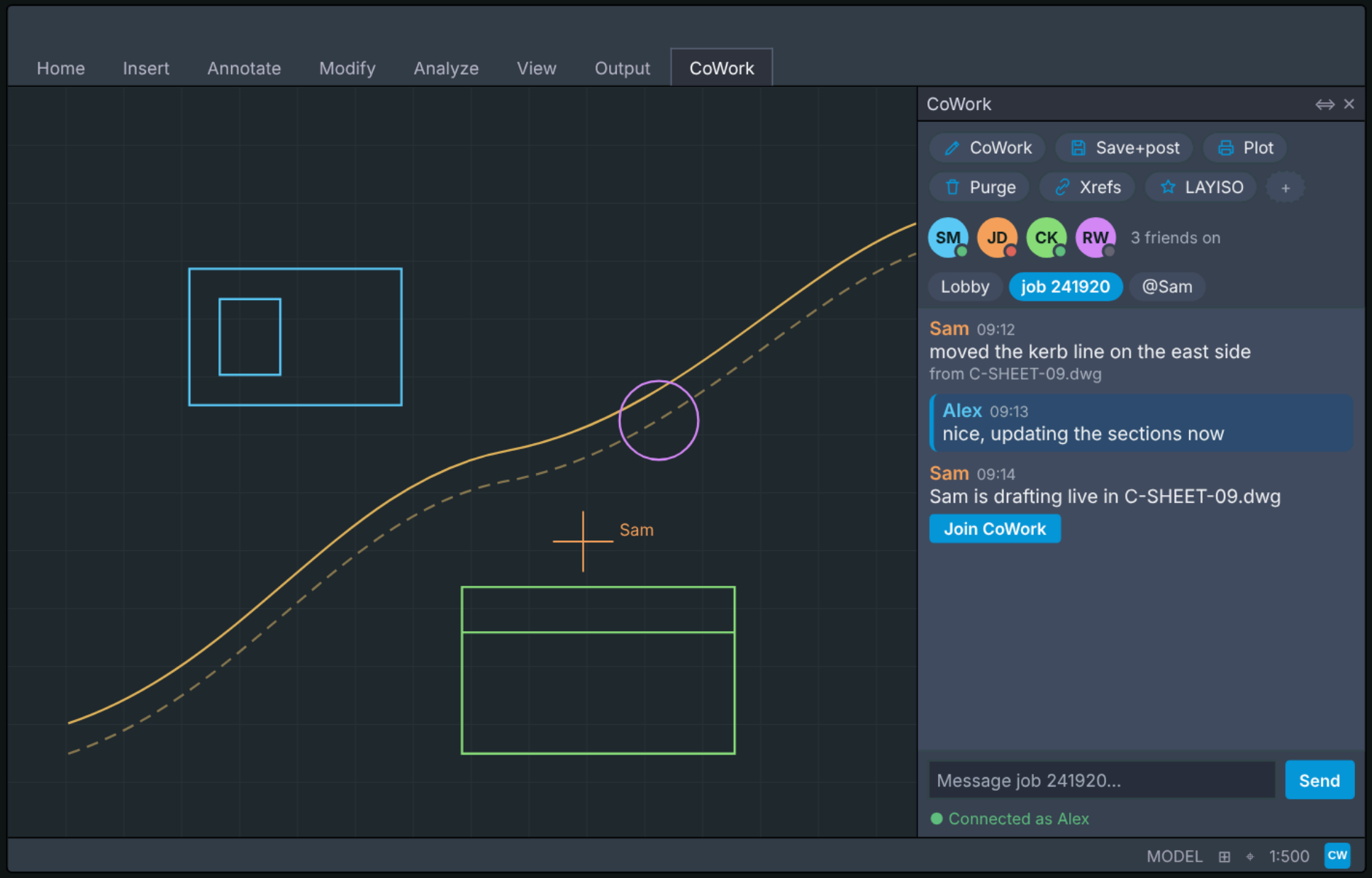
4 · Civil 3D · Slim icon strip that opens out

Takes almost no screen space: a 46-pixel strip of icons docked to the edge. Click an icon and its panel slides out (Friends is open here), then it tucks away again, like auto-hide. Red badges show unread messages. Your own commands sit at the bottom of the strip.



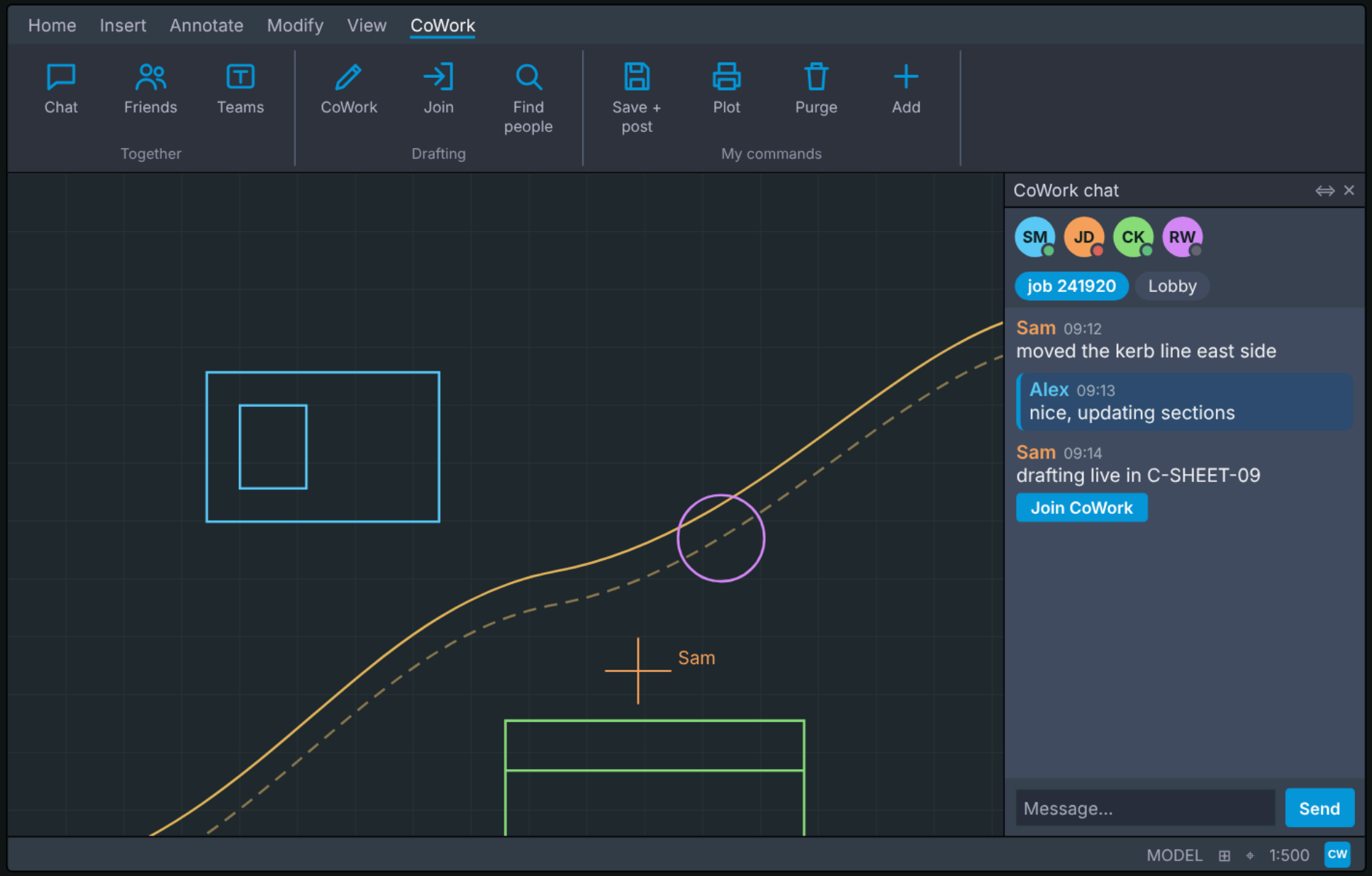
5 · Civil 3D · All in one: quick buttons above the chat

One panel does everything: a row of your custom command buttons at the top, friends' faces underneath (click one to message them), then the chat. You don't need to switch tabs, so it suits people who keep the chat open all day.



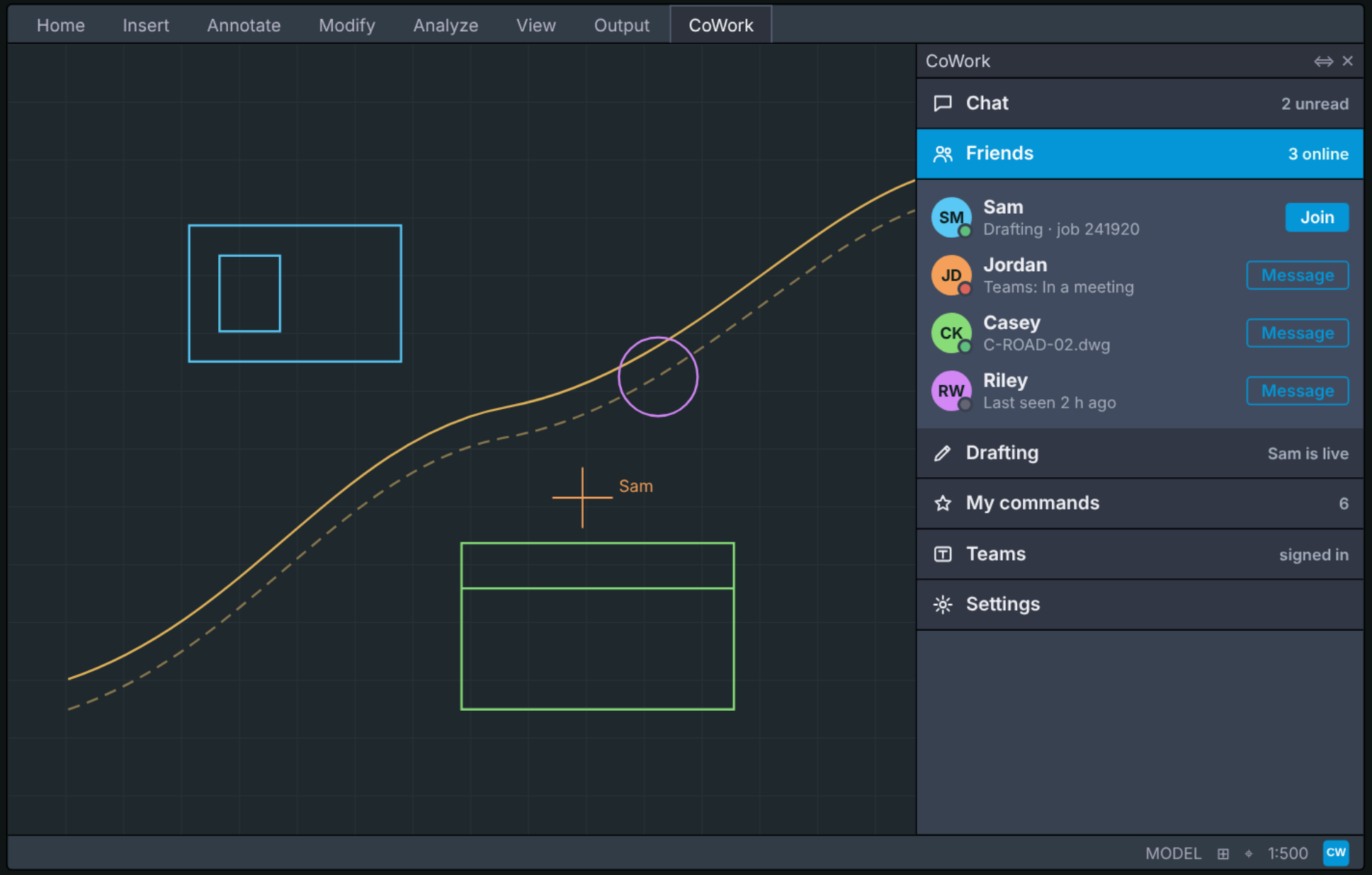
6 · Civil 3D · Ribbon tab plus a small docked chat

Your commands go on a "CoWork" ribbon tab, with big buttons in groups you can customise just like the rest of the ribbon. The docked panel then only has to hold the chat and friends, so it can stay narrow.



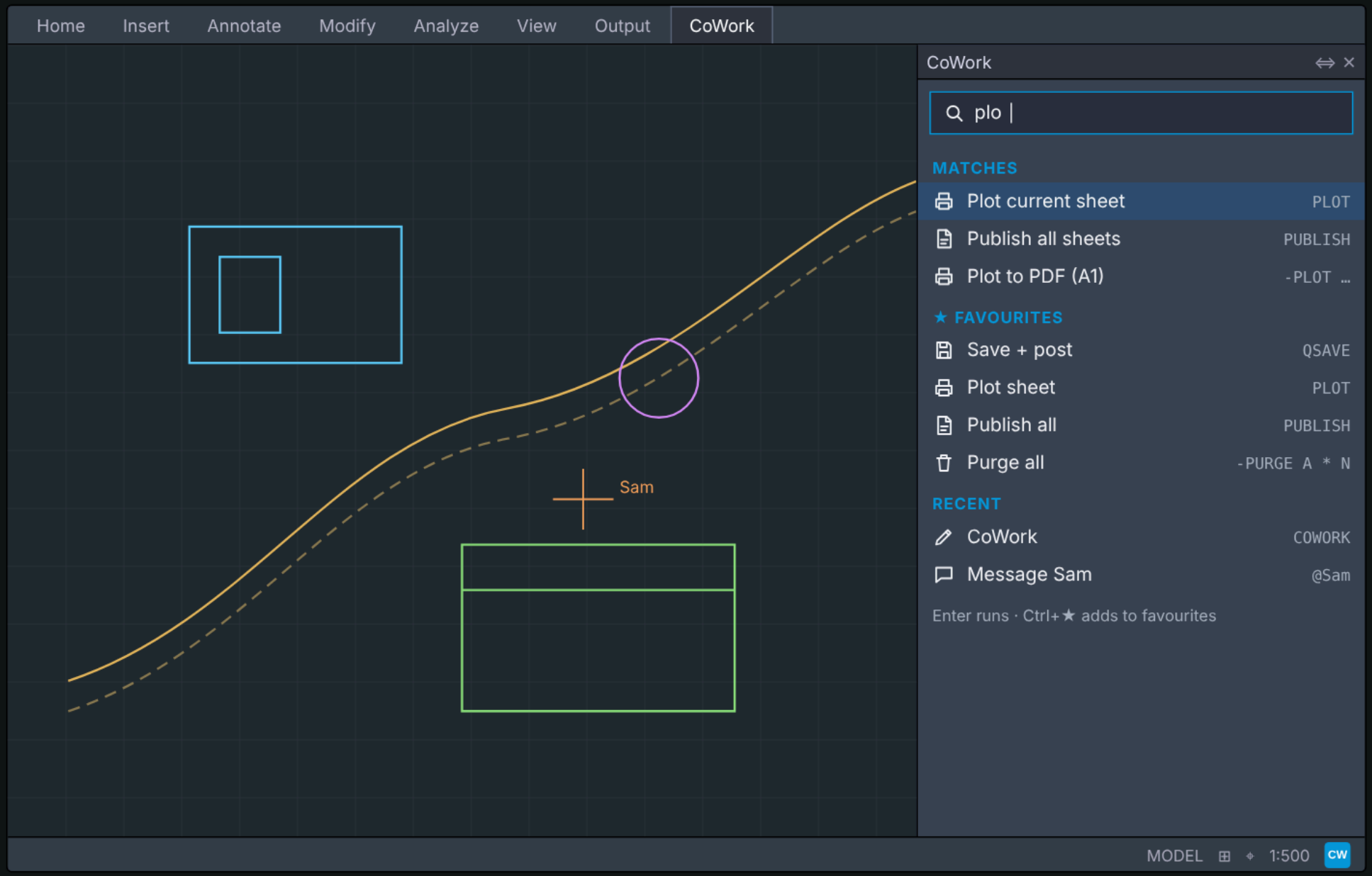
7 · Civil 3D · Accordion: one big section open at a time

Four big headers (Chat, Friends, Drafting, My commands), and clicking one opens it and closes the others. It is very clear to read, and the headers carry live counts like "2 unread" and "3 online".



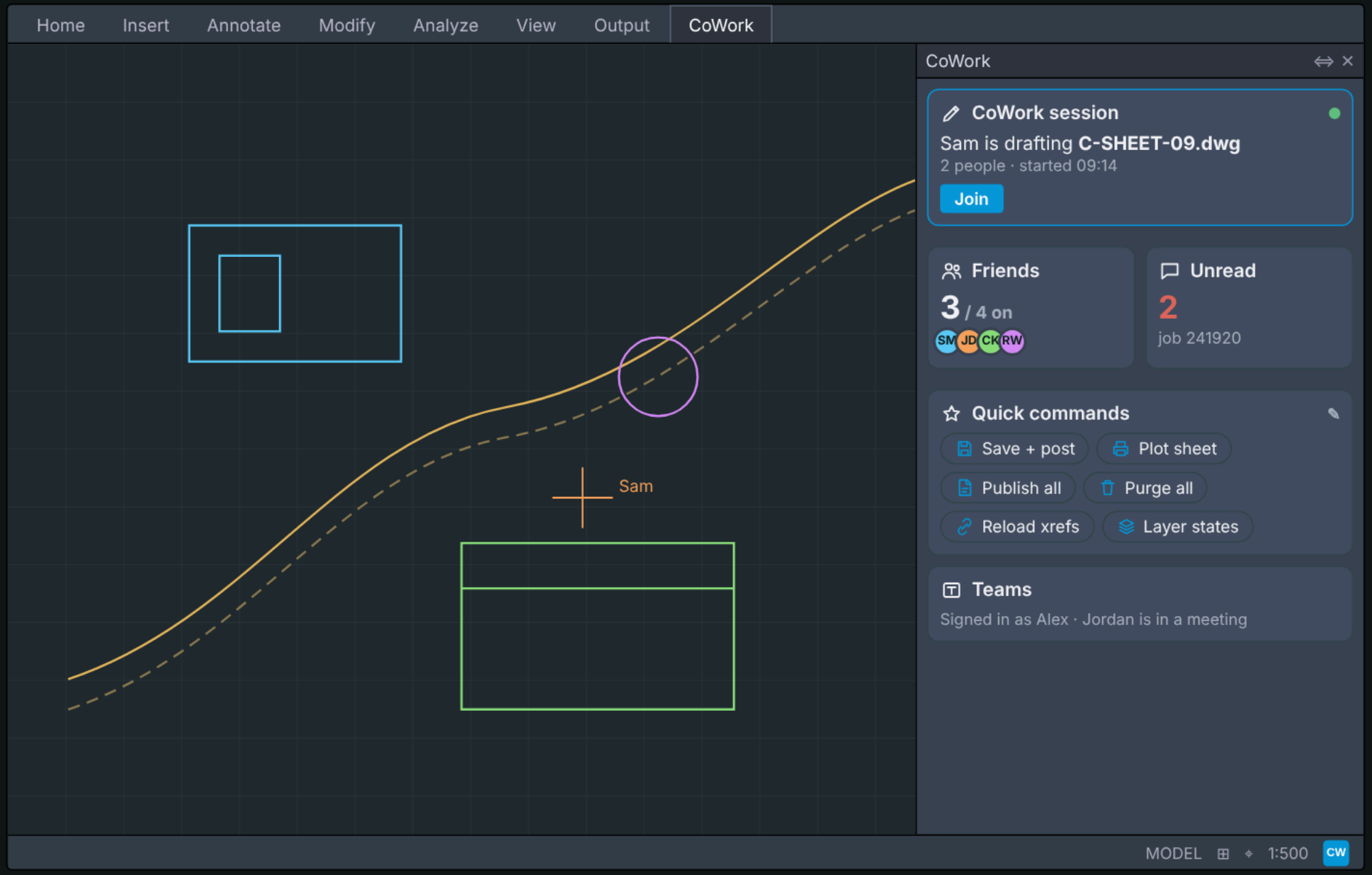
8 · Civil 3D · Command search launcher

A search box at the top: type "plot" and the matching commands appear. Underneath are your starred favourites and the commands you used recently. This suits people who know what they want and prefer typing to clicking.



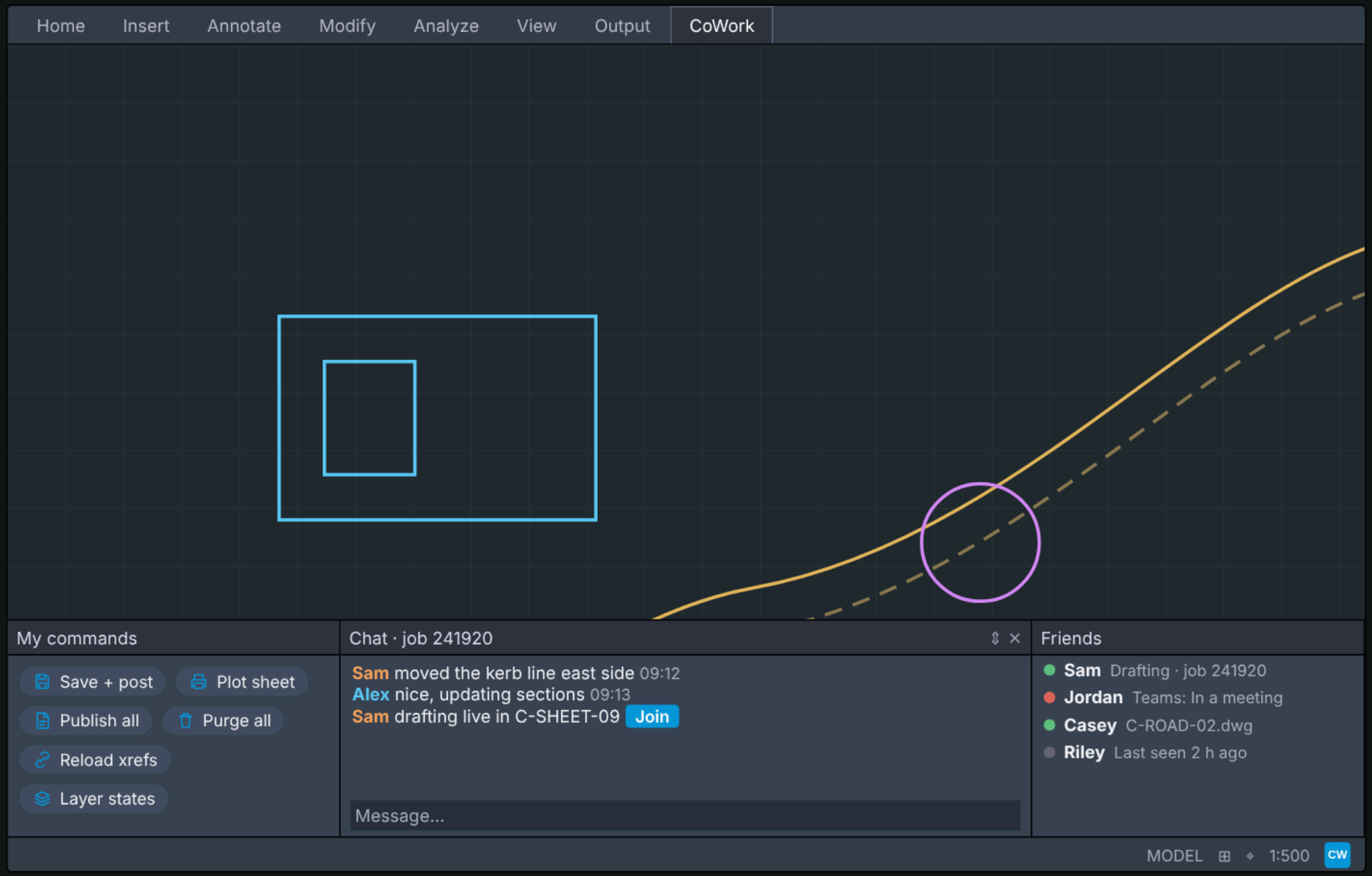
9 · Civil 3D · Dashboard cards

Stacked cards that each show a live status: the drafting session, friends online, unread messages and your quick commands. You can see what is going on without opening anything, and you can drag cards up or down or hide them.



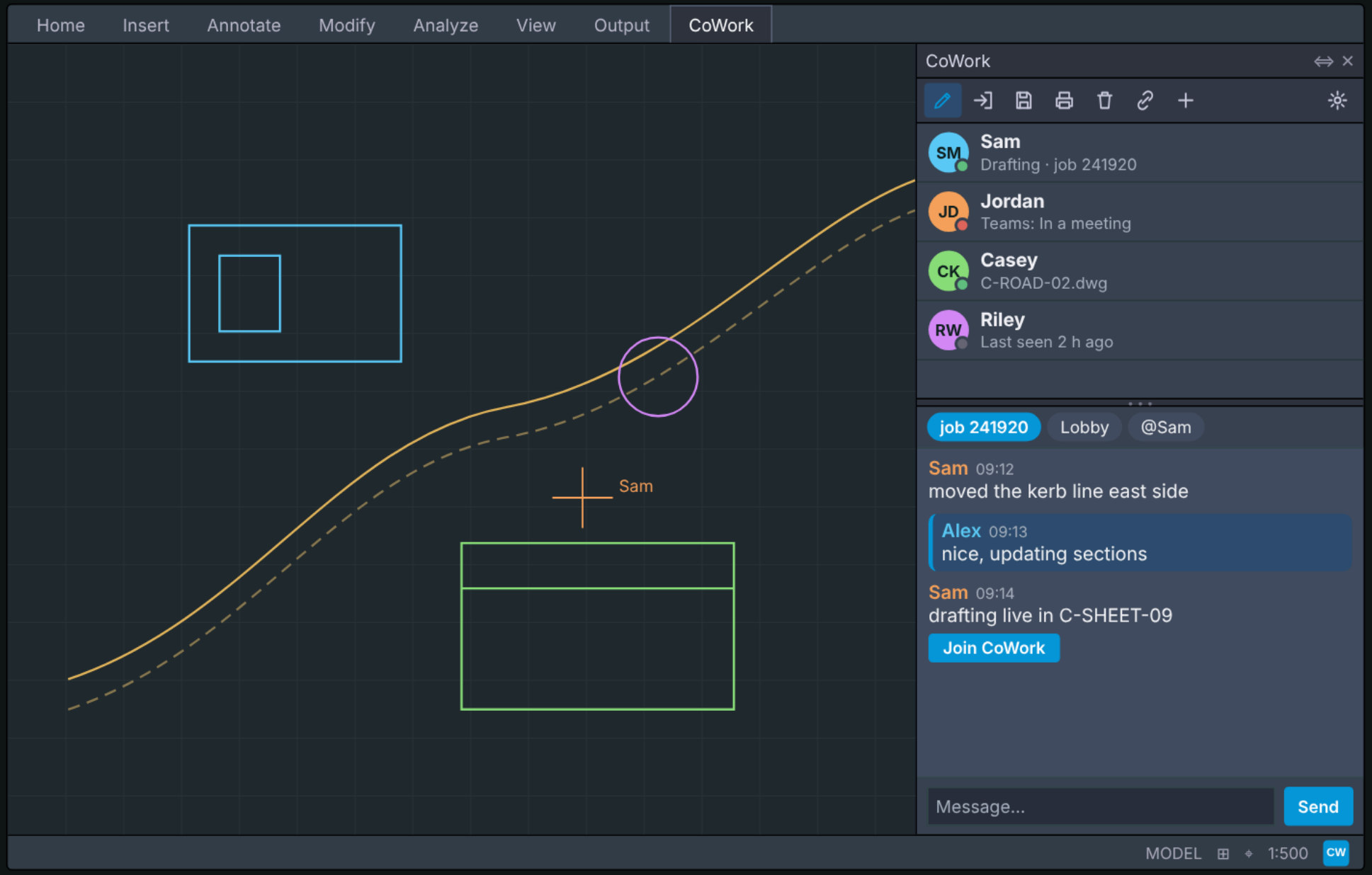
10 · Civil 3D · Docked along the bottom, like the command line

A wide, short panel under the drawing with three columns: your commands, the chat and friends. It keeps the full height of the screen free for the drawing, which works well on wide monitors.



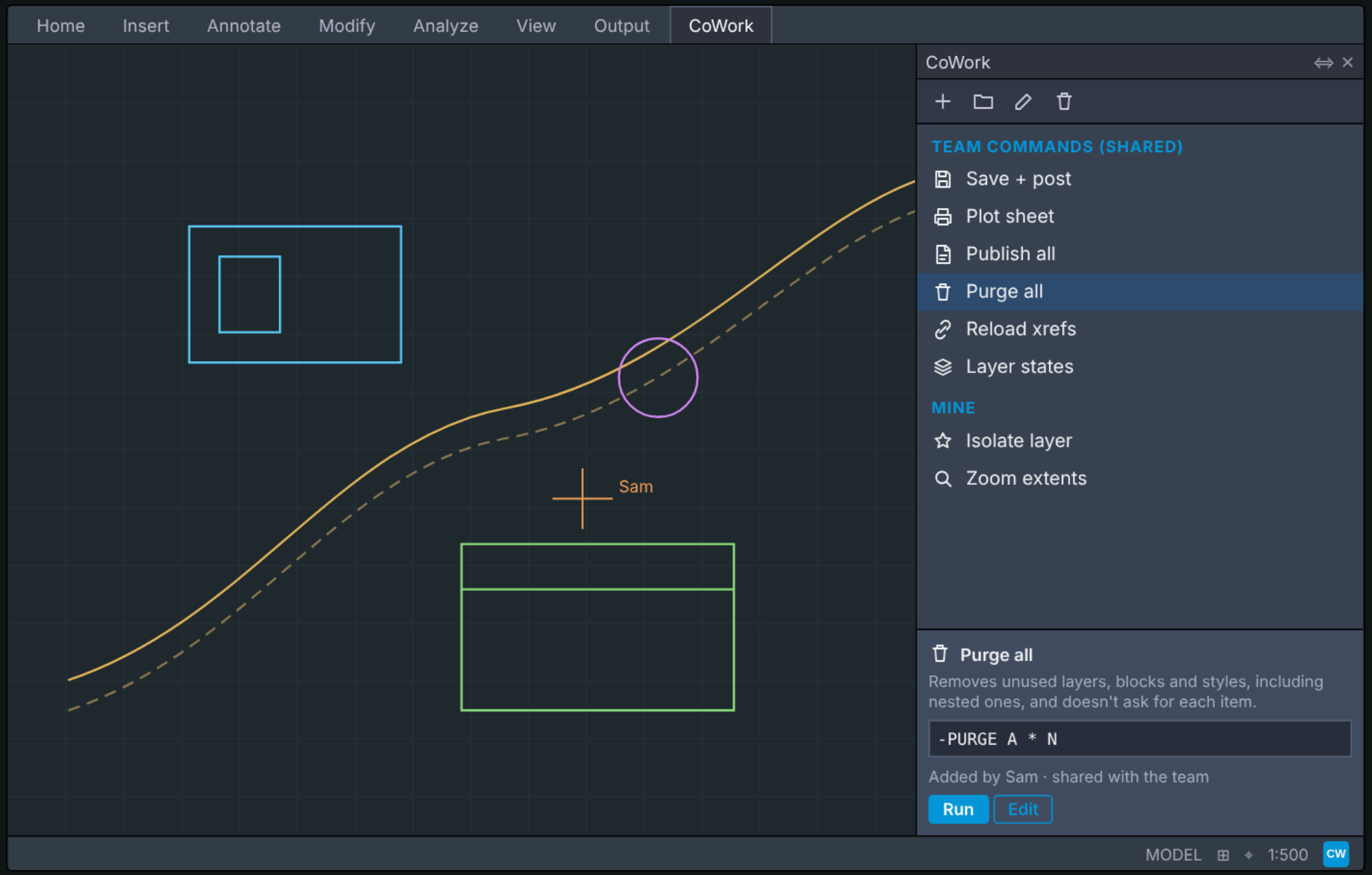
11 · Civil 3D · Split: friends on top, chat below

Friends sit in the top half and the chat in the bottom half, with a bar between them you can drag. A small toolbar under the title holds your commands as icons, the same way Toolspace has its own toolbar.



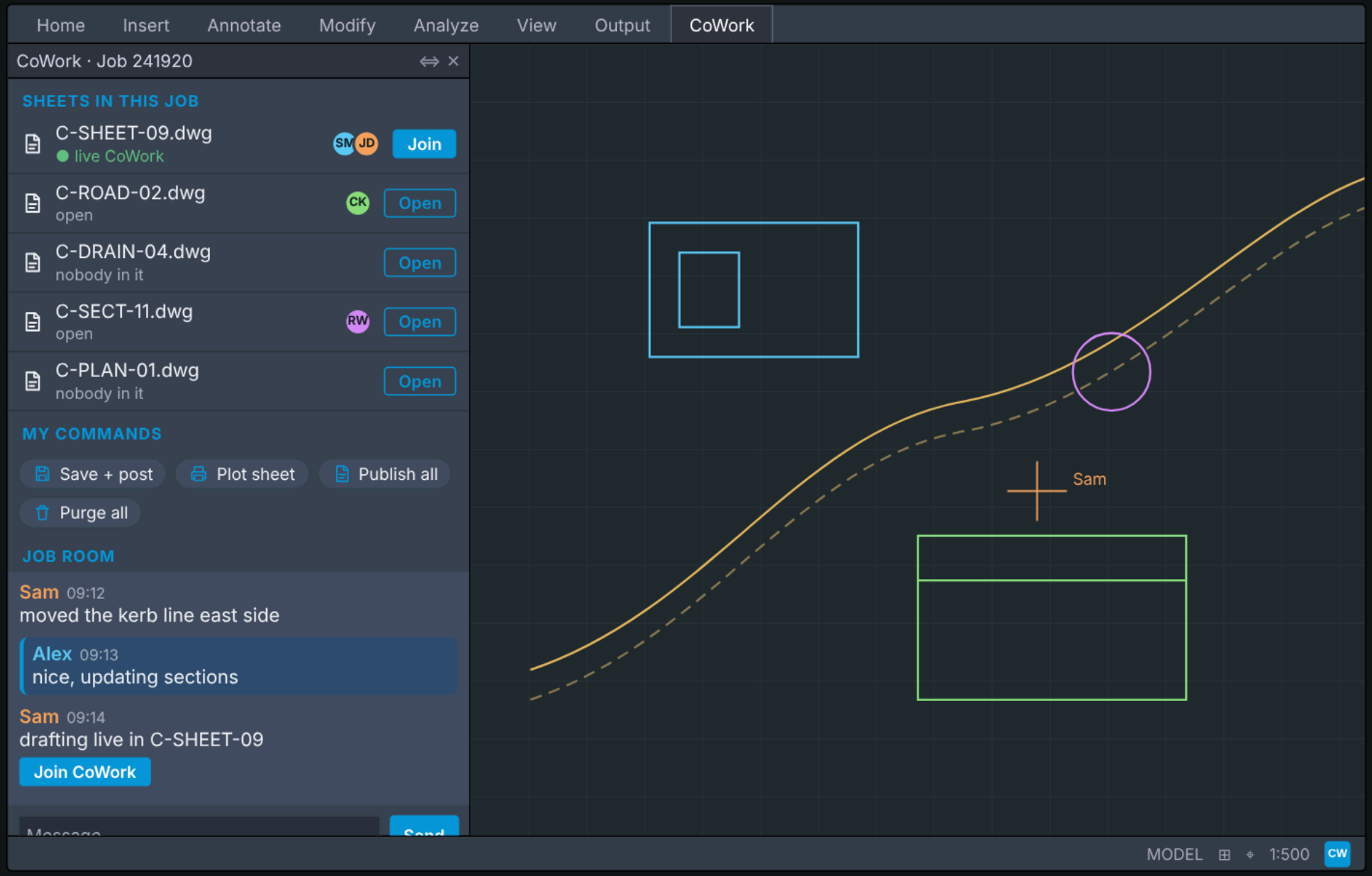
12 · Civil 3D · List with a preview pane (Prospector style)

A list of commands on top. Select one and the pane underneath explains what it does and shows the exact command line it runs, then double-click to run it. This makes shared team commands easy to understand.



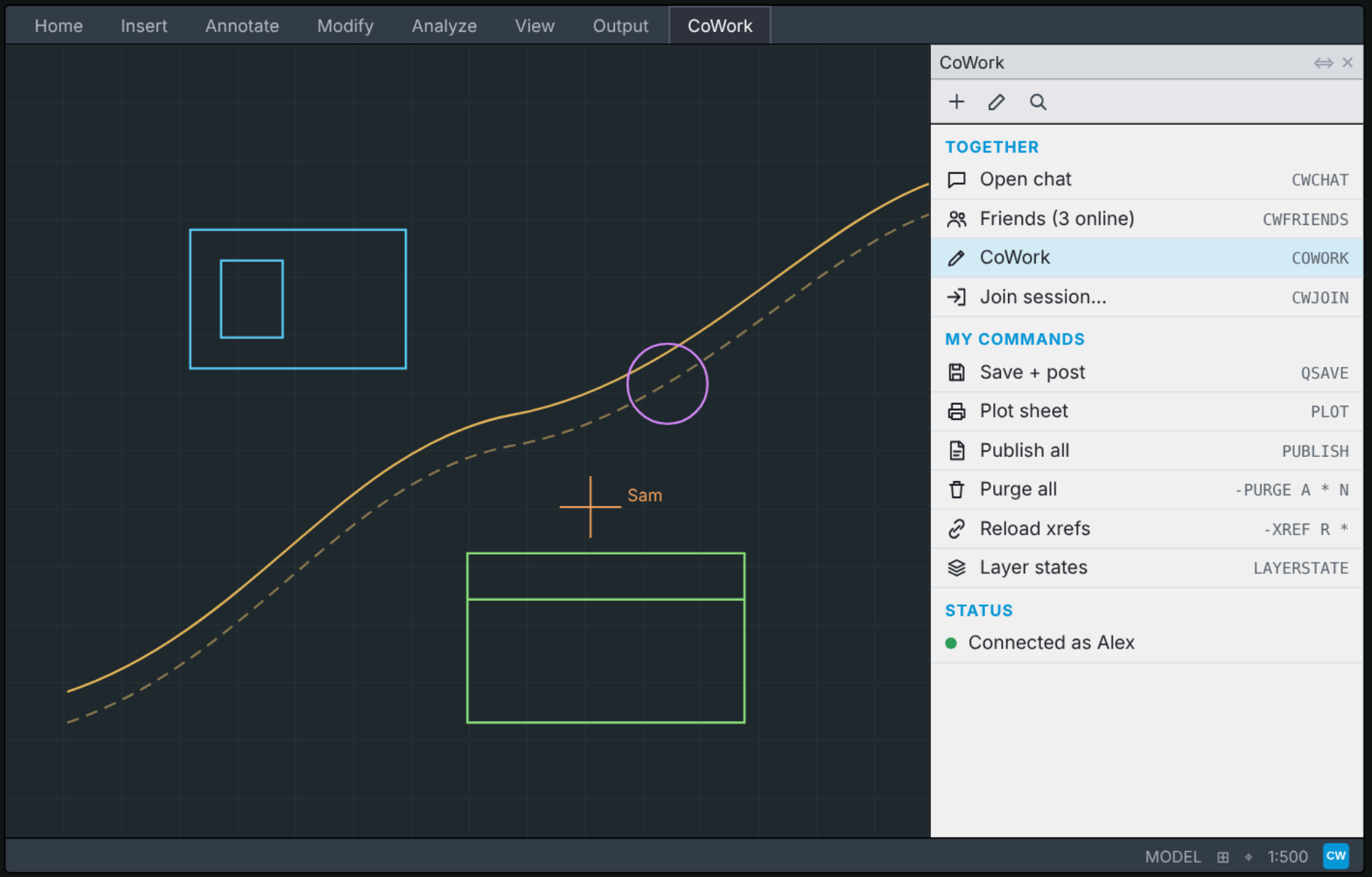
13 · Civil 3D · Job view, docked on the left

Organised around the job instead of the tool: the sheets in job 241920, who is in each one right now, and a button to open or join. Your commands and the job room chat sit underneath. It is docked on the left, where Toolspace usually lives.



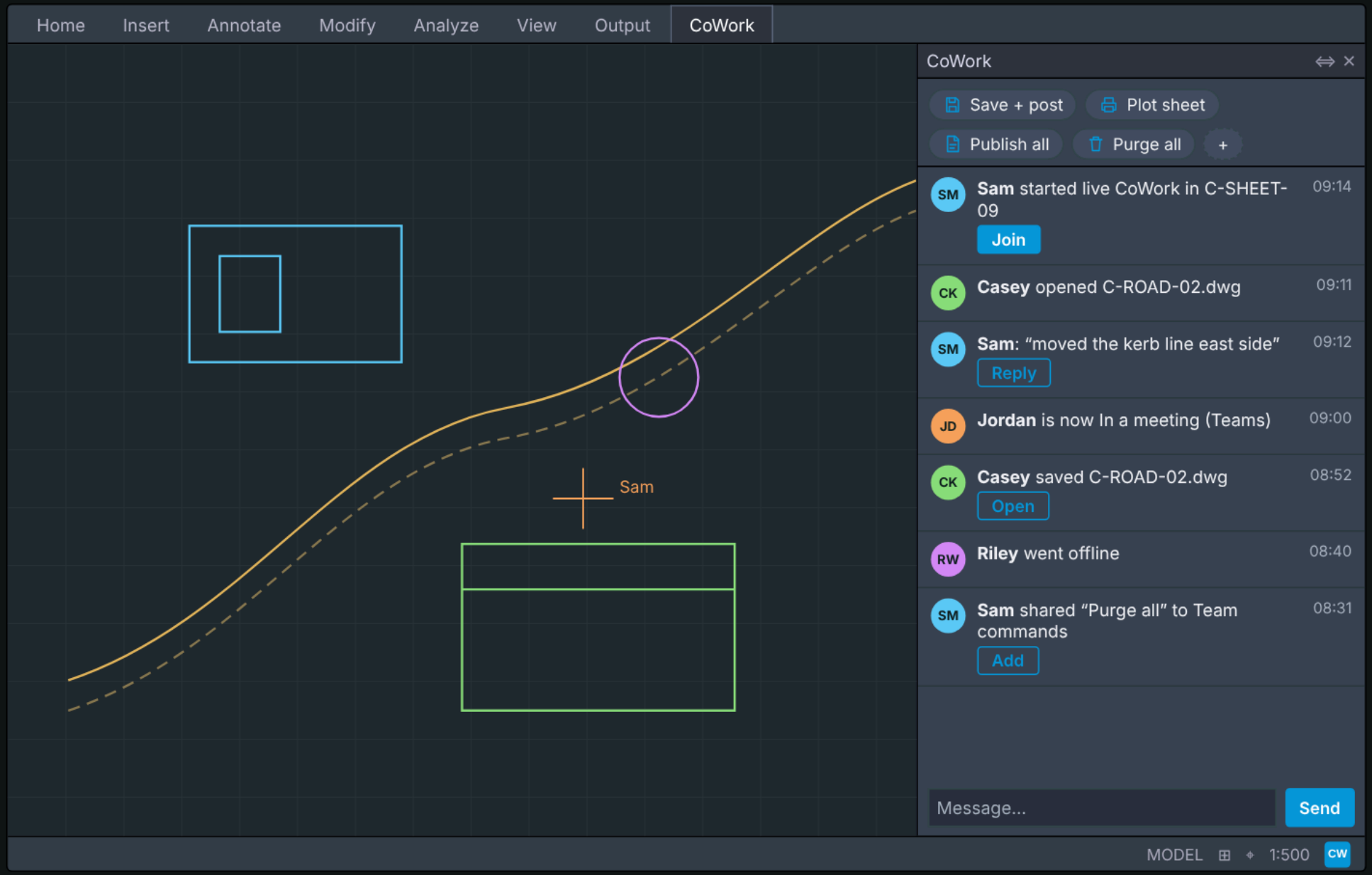
14 · Civil 3D · Classic AutoCAD light grey

The same menu drawn in the light grey style of classic AutoCAD and Windows: plain rows with icons, keyboard shortcuts on the right and grouped headings. It fits in with older palettes and is useful if you run Civil 3D in its light theme.



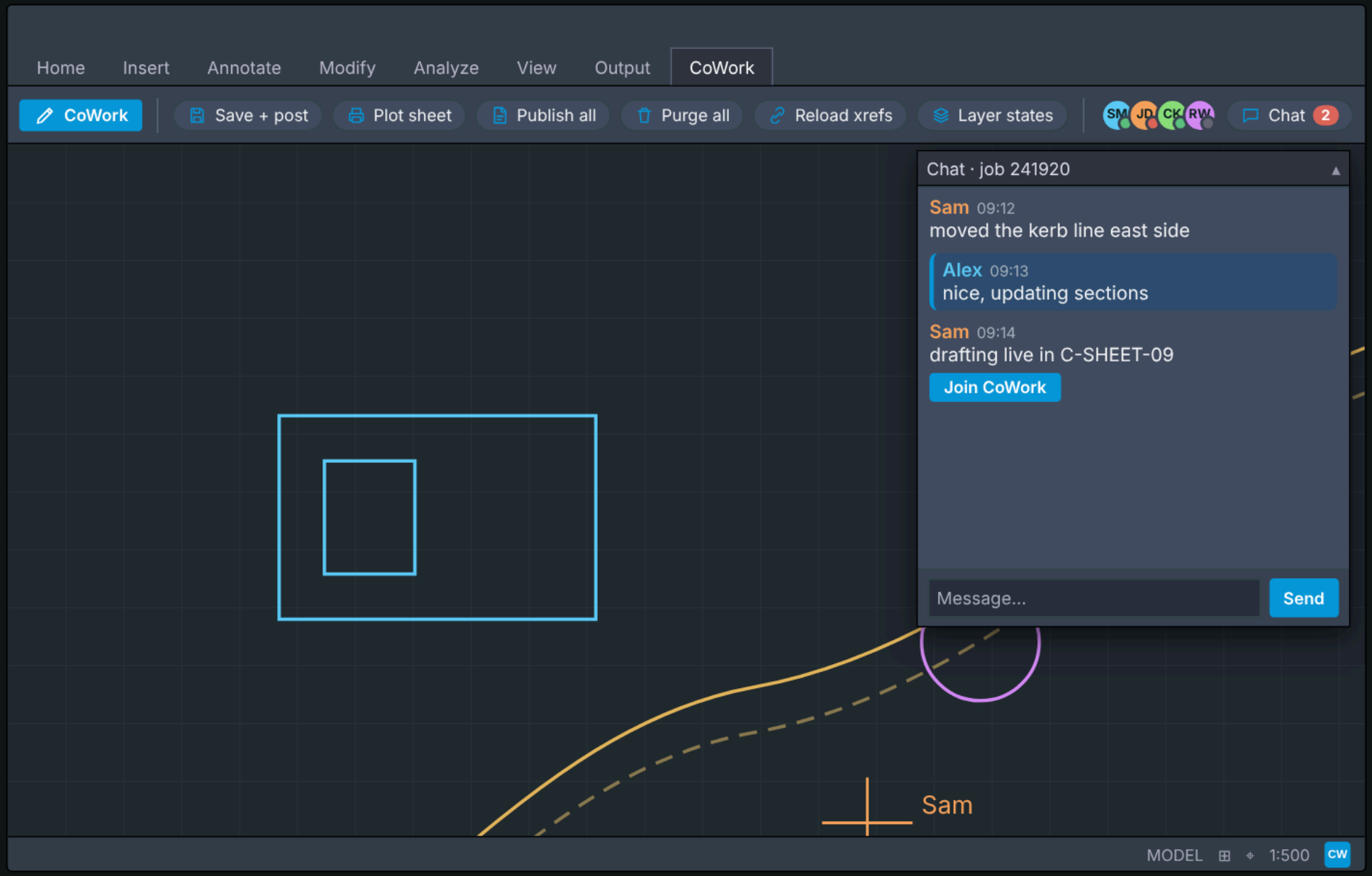
15 · Civil 3D · Activity feed

A running feed of what is happening: Sam saved a sheet, Casey joined the drafting session, a new message arrives. Each item has a button to act on it, and your commands are pinned along the top. It feels like a live team noticeboard.



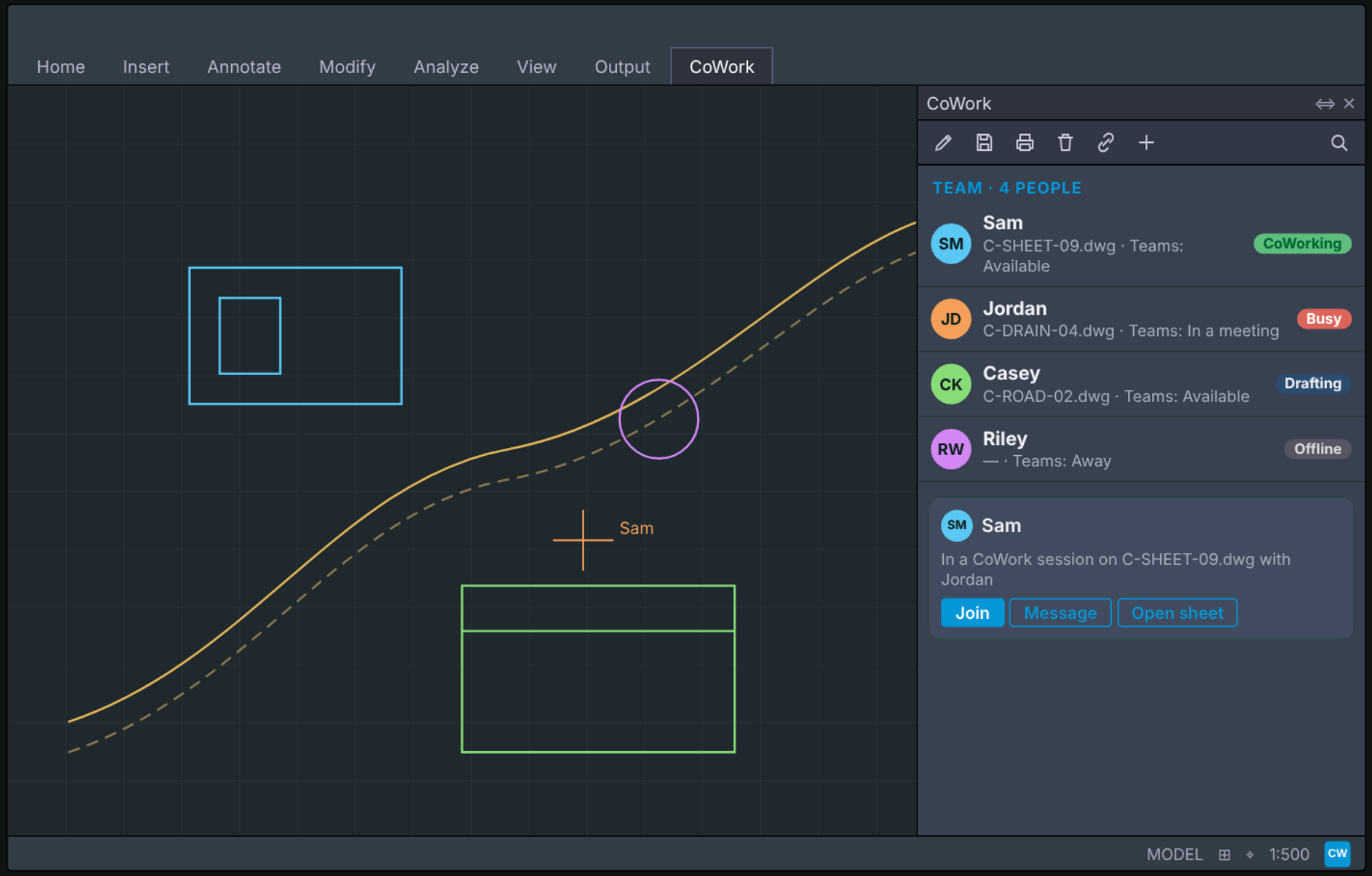
16 · Civil 3D · Toolbar strip under the ribbon

A slim bar docked across the top of the drawing, like an extra toolbar row. It holds your commands, the CoWork button, friends' faces and an unread count, and clicking any of them drops the full panel down. It takes no side space at all.



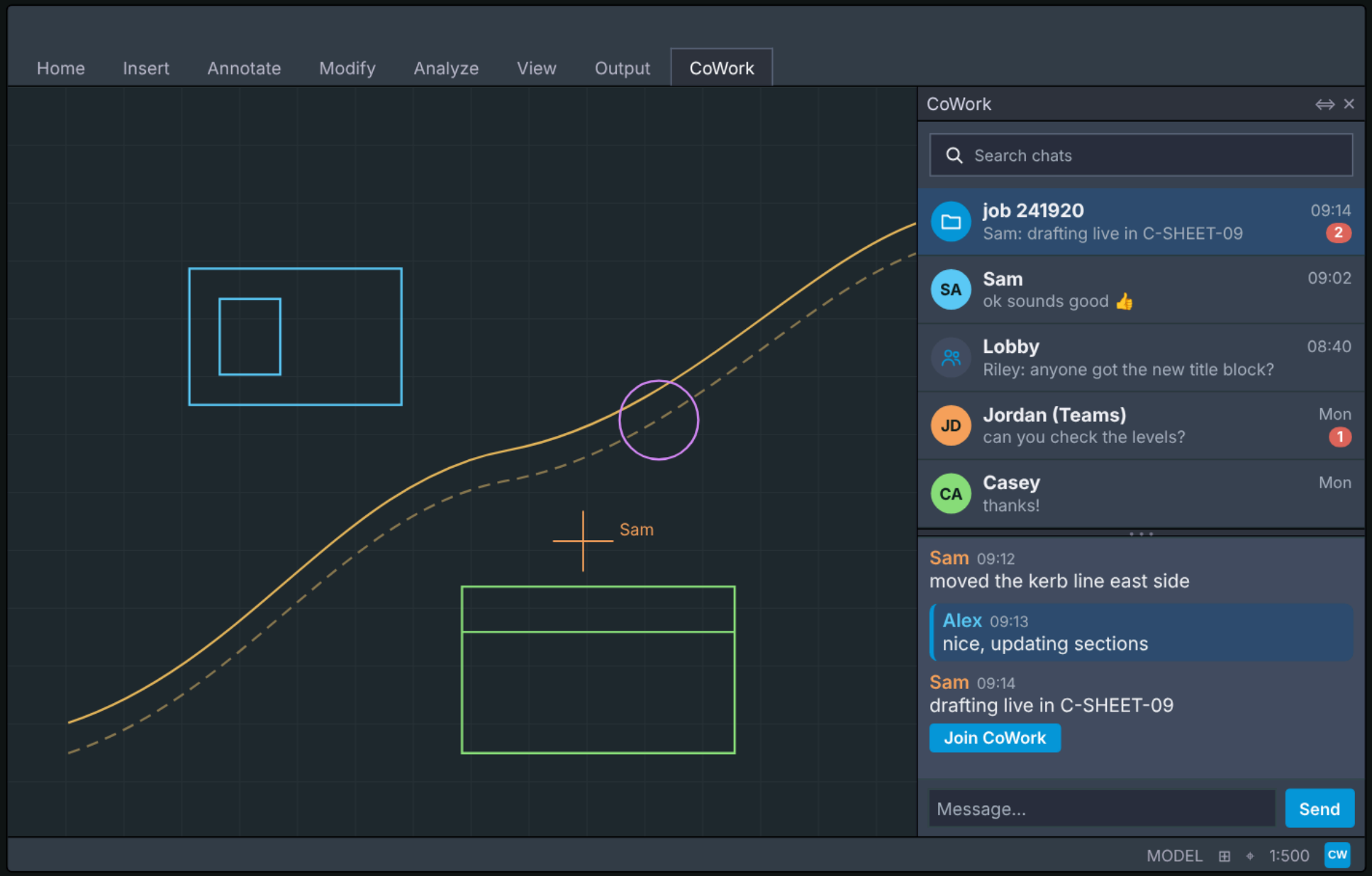
17 · Civil 3D · Team roster

A clean list of everyone on the team, showing what each person is doing right now: their sheet, whether they are in a CoWork session, and their Teams status. Click a person to message them, join their session or open their sheet. Your commands are in the toolbar.



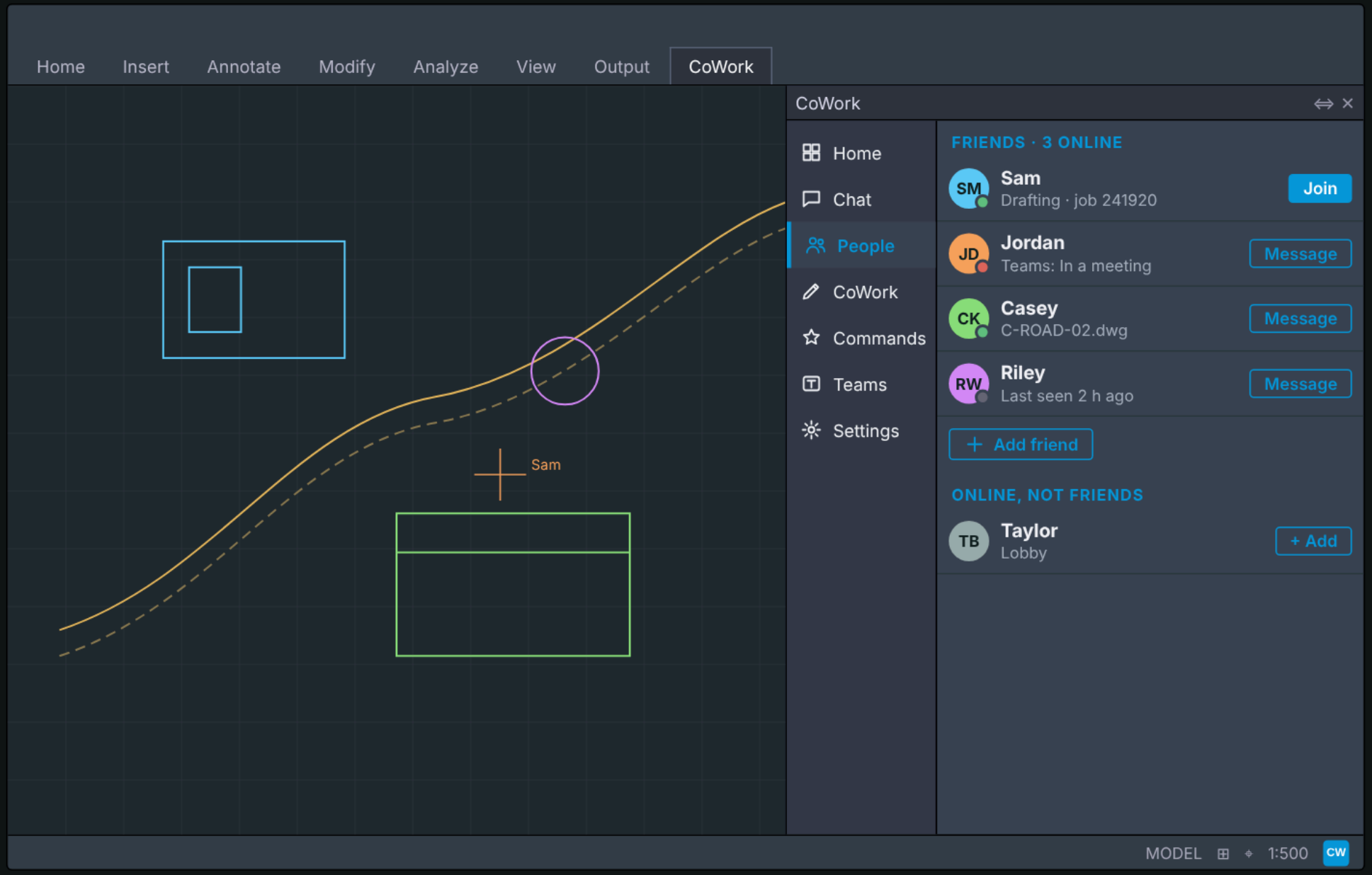
18 · Civil 3D · Messenger style: conversations list

Like the chat list in Teams: every room and private chat in one list, with the latest message and an unread badge. Clicking a conversation opens it in the lower half of the panel.



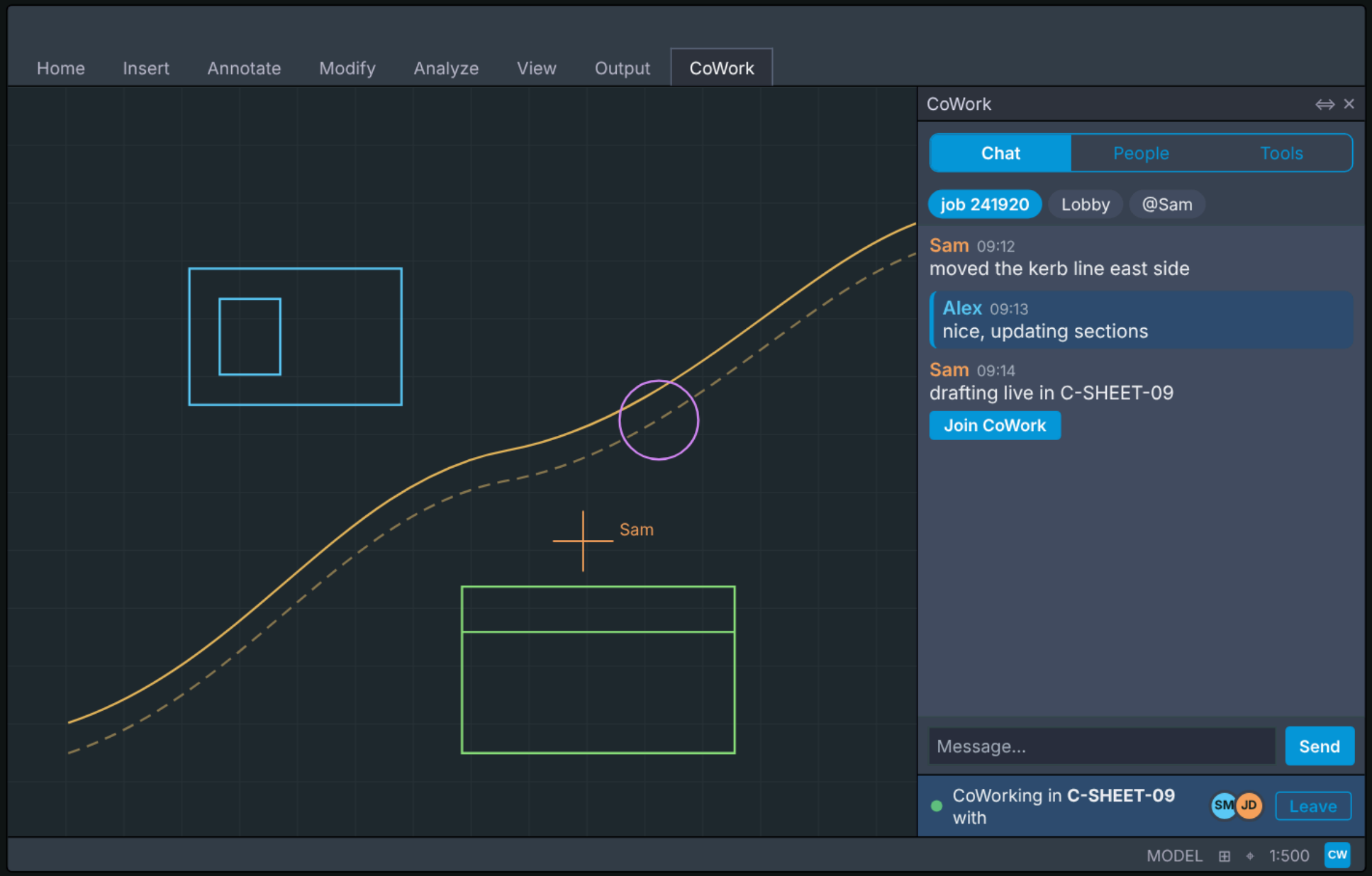
19 · Civil 3D · Side menu plus page

A wider panel with a labelled menu down its left side (Home, Chat, People, CoWork, Commands, Settings) and the selected page on the right. It works like a small app inside Civil 3D, with everything one click away.



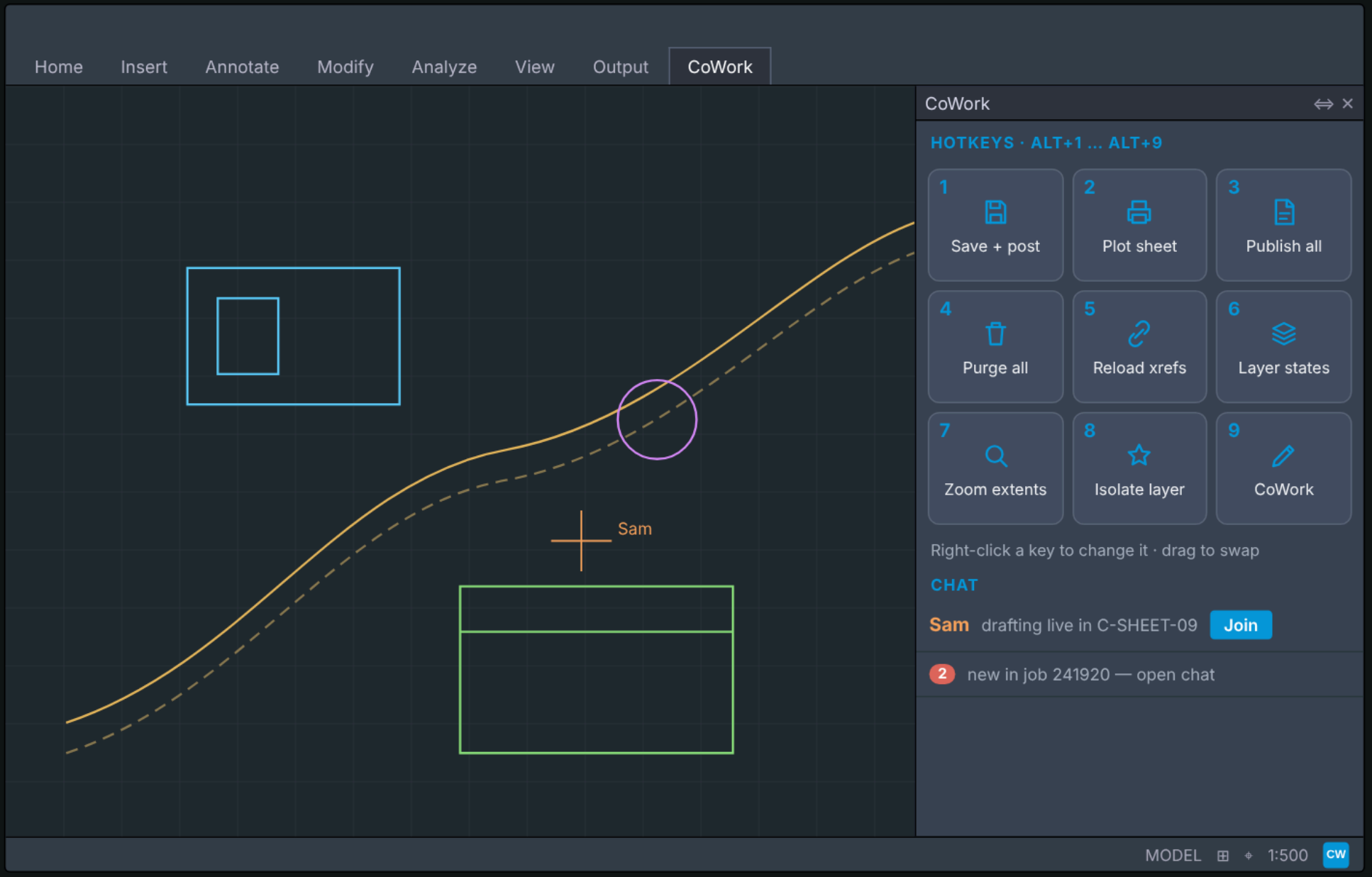
20 · Civil 3D · Segmented tabs with a live banner

Three big switch-tabs at the top (Chat, People, Tools). When you are in a CoWork session, a banner pinned to the bottom shows who is drafting with you and has a Leave button. It is simple and clean.



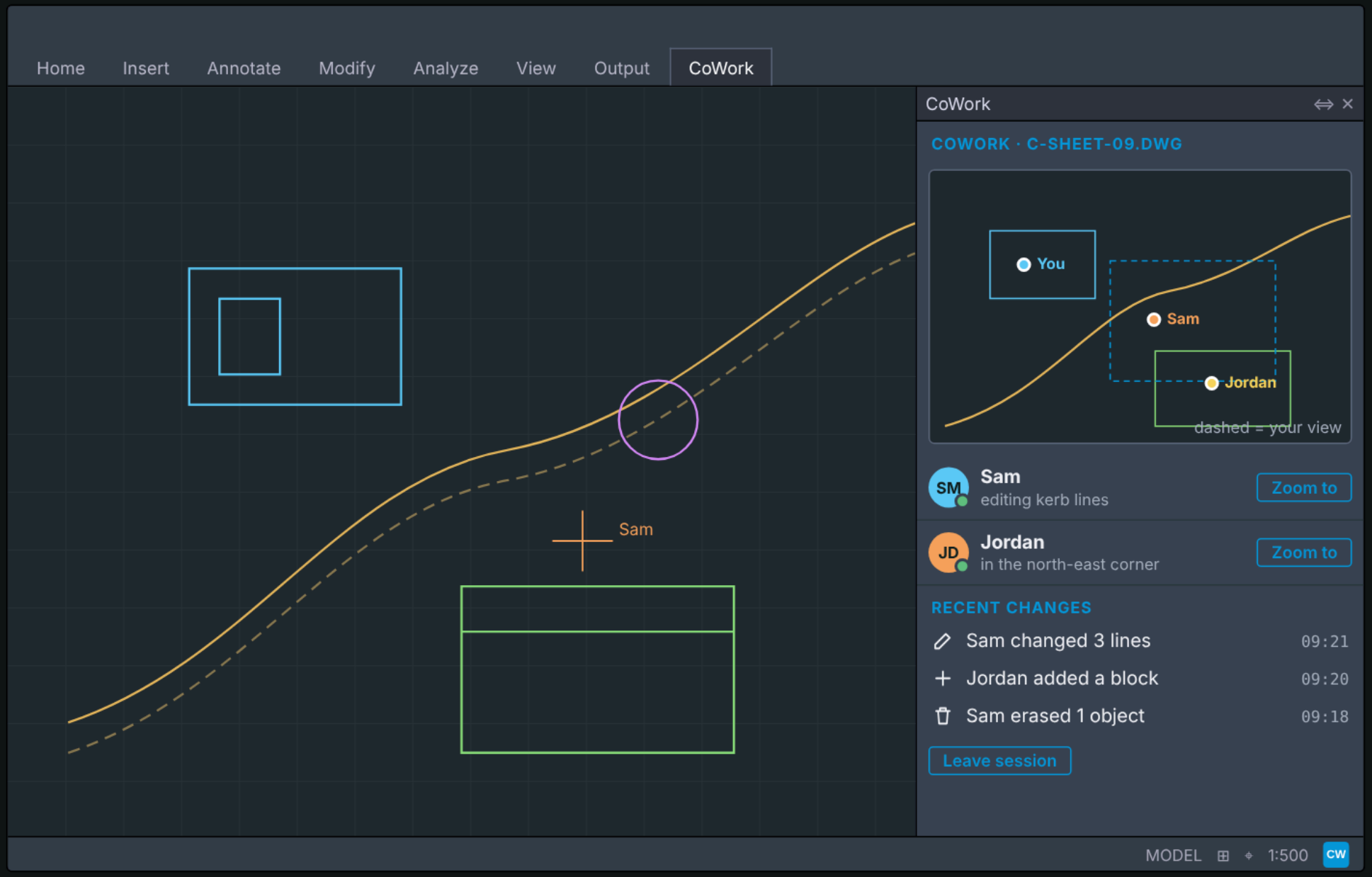
21 · Civil 3D · Numbered hotkey pad

Nine big numbered buttons, each running one of your commands. Press Alt+1 to Alt+9 to fire them without touching the mouse. It suits people who repeat the same handful of commands all day.



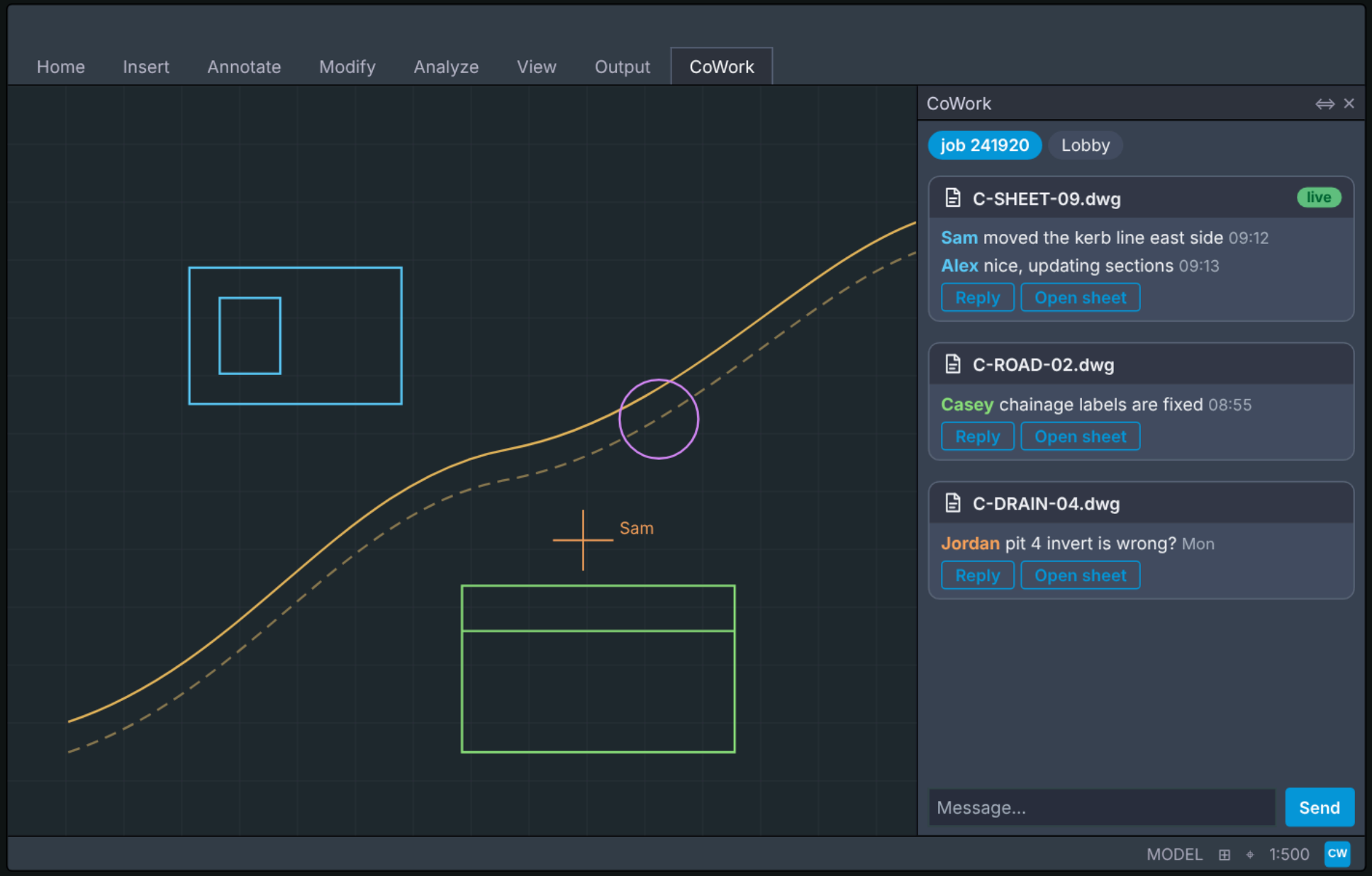
22 · Civil 3D · CoWork session map

A live mini map of the drawing showing where everyone's crosshair is, each in that person's colour. Click a person to zoom to them. Underneath are the session's people and recent changes.



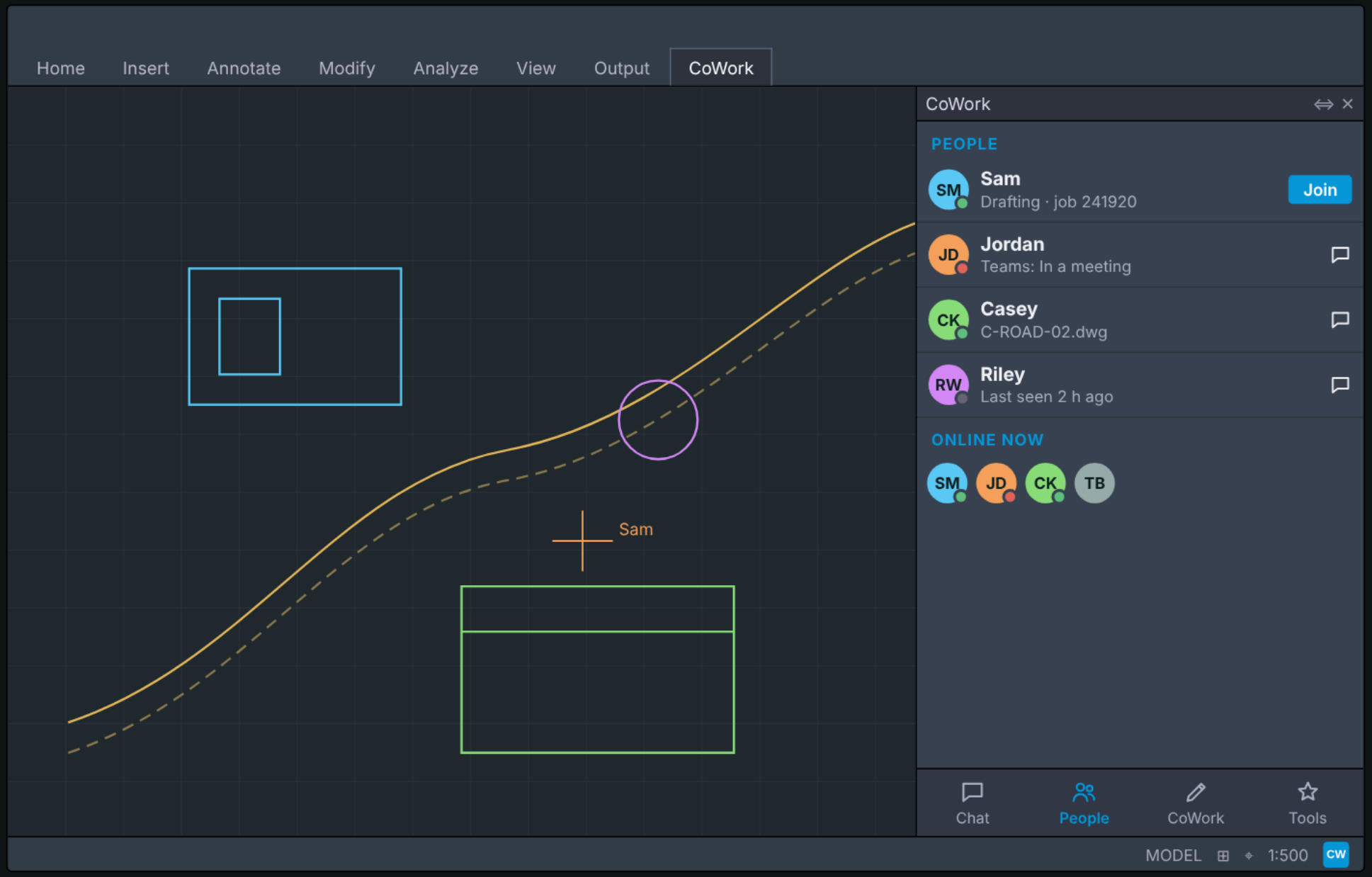
23 · Civil 3D · Threads by drawing

Messages are grouped by the drawing they are about, so each sheet has its own thread card with its latest messages, a Reply button and an Open sheet button. It is easy to keep conversations about different sheets apart.



24 · Civil 3D · Bottom tab bar

Phone-app style: the page fills the panel and four big tabs sit along the bottom (Chat, People, CoWork, Tools). They are easy to reach and familiar to anyone who uses apps on their phone.



25 · Civil 3D · Home screen

A start page: a greeting, one big CoWork button, the last session to rejoin, recent drawings and quick commands. It answers "what do I do next?" at a glance, and the other pages are a click away.

